

Thomas Ratliff

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Summary

Technical Artist with 5+ years building and shipping XR experiences in Unity. Experience in rapid prototyping across VR, MR, and mobile, as well as performance optimization, 3D design, real-time shaders, and VFX.

Experience

Scripting Technical Artist | Meta (Contract via Insight Global) | Burlingame, CA | April 2025 - Present

- Building prototypes for AI-native game creation tools that generate assets and gameplay logic from natural-language prompts, proving out generative AI workflows for game development
- Collaborated with artists and designers to implement 3D assets, VFX, and runtime logic for Horizon Central, the central hub for Horizon Worlds, shown at Meta Connect 2025
- Worked with team of Technical Artists to implement CDN based optimizations to reduce loading time between 50-player Horizon Central worlds on Quest hardware to below 10 seconds while maintaining visual fidelity

Technical Artist | HTC Creative Labs | Remote | January 2023 – April 2025

- Delivered content experiences for metaverse research prototypes, partnering with research, design, and engineering stakeholders from concept through demo
- Built demo experiences validating newly released Vive developer APIs and showcasing mixed reality capabilities on Vive Focus Vision hardware
- Raised runtime visual quality of home environments shipped in the Vive Focus Vision OS, driving lighting, shaders, VFX, and performance alongside the team's 3D artist

Technical Artist | Remio VR | Remote | March 2021 – December 2022

- Shipped VR collaboration tools and team-building games using Unity adopted by public and enterprise customers
- Hit Quest standalone performance targets by optimizing meshes, materials, shaders, textures, cutting draw calls
- Produced 3D characters, environments and in-game objects, shaders, particle effects, and animations

Technical Artist | MAGIC Spell Studios | Rochester, NY | May 2020 – December 2020

- Worked with a small agile team to develop prototypes in Unity for a MAGIC Spell Studios original game
- Designed and developed VFX (shaders and particle systems) as well as player UI systems
- Accelerated asset integration by partnering with artists on in-engine standards for characters, props, and audio

Skills

Languages: C#, TypeScript, HLSL, C++, JavaScript, Java

XR: Unity URP, Unity Profiler, Perfetto, Shader Graph, Meta XR SDK, OpenXR, XR Interaction Toolkit, FMOD, Unreal Engine

Art: Blender, Maya, ZBrush, Substance Painter (PBR Workflows), Photoshop

Tools: Git, GitHub, Visual Studio, AI Assisted pipelines (Claude Code, Codex, Meshy AI)

Projects

Party Crashers | Personal Project | partycrashers.app/home | April 2021 - Present

- Creating a VR party game where players join from phones as controllers via WebGL, networked with Normcore
- Designing, implementing, and optimizing models, textures, and shaders to meet the game's visual goals

VRTistry | Personal Project | vrtistry.app | August 2025 - Present

- Creating a Pictionary-inspired VR party game. Standalone minigame from Party Crashers
- Integrated vision-based AI to interpret player-created artwork and generate fun, context-aware guess choices

Quest Camera Kit | Open Source Contribution | github.com/xrdevrob/QuestCameraKit | March 2025

- Contributed passthrough shader samples and camera-based lighting and reflection estimation prototypes to a 555-star community reference project for Meta Quest's Passthrough Camera API

Luminar | Personal Project | tinyurl.com/luminarwebbrowser | November 2023 - Present

- Developing mixed reality web browsing app with real-time lighting visual effects, published on Meta Horizon Store

Education

Rochester Institute of Technology (RIT), Rochester, NY | August 2017 – December 2020

Bachelor of Science, Major in Game Design & Development, Minors in 3D Digital Design and Psychology

GPA: 3.72 | Dean's List Fall 2017 – 2020 | Honors: *magna cum laude*